colava

01

FOOD FORMS

CHOCOLATE & DESSERT INSERTS

A PRACTICAL GUIDE



Your first Food workbench.

A focused path: chocolate discs, hollow hemispheres and fruit inserts.

01

What you will learn

Choose a suitable cavity, calculate a batch, fill with control and recognise when to release it. Three progressive exercises teach different skills; repeat each before changing the material or shape.

02

How to use these pages

Read pages 3-8 first. Complete project 1, record the result on page 21, then move to shells once your crystallisation check succeeds. Frozen inserts follow a separate workflow. Practice batches are small and scalable.

03

Inside this volume

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04

Scope and images

This book uses ready-made food molds. It does not teach silicone manufacture or formulate shelf-stable fillings. Photographic images are AI concepts; diagrams are teaching schematics. These exercises are not represented as laboratory trials performed by COLAVA.

Match the mold to the material.

The same outline can call for different molds.

01

Solid chocolate

Open cavity, even rim, few fragile details. A rigid chocolate mold makes surface finish and contraction easier to assess. Silicone can work, but its flexibility and cavity finish affect the result.

02

Thin shell

For this exercise, use a rigid hemisphere mold intended for chocolate. Its rim must allow excess chocolate to be removed without damaging the mold. A deep shape with many undercuts adds unnecessary difficulty to a first trial.

03

Frozen insert

Small silicone cavities let you peel the wall away from the piece. Choose a volume smaller than the final dessert. Check width and height too: two shapes with the same volume may still not fit inside one another.

04

What to check in the product information

Intended food use, temperature limits, cleaning instructions and dimensions. Keep the mold brand and product code. Blue colour, smell or the word “silicone” alone do not establish suitability; never move a candle-used mold into food work.

How much does a cavity hold?

Measure volume first. Then establish the mass of your ingredient.

12	×	8 g	=	96 g
cavities		per cavity		in the product

+ measured working allowance

The water check

Place the clean mold on a tray and tare the scale. Fill one cavity with water to the intended level. For a kitchen estimate, 20 g of water is approximately 20 ml. Repeat for three cavities and average the results. Clean and dry completely before chocolate work.

Volume is not weight

Do not automatically convert 20 ml into 20 g of chocolate or mousse. Use documented density if available, or weigh a sample cavity filled with your preparation. For a shell, weigh the released piece: its mass is far lower than that of a full cavity.

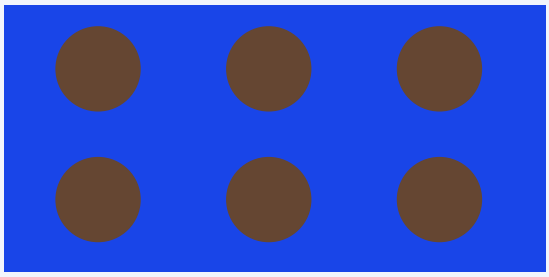
Planning example

12 cavities × 8 g measured = 96 g in the product. With an illustrative 15% working allowance: 96 × 1.15 = 110.4 g. This allows for the bowl and drips; it is not a mandatory loss. Shell casting requires more circulating chocolate, which is then recovered cleanly.

Record: volume / sample mass / cavity count / batch mass.

01 / Solid chocolate discs.

Your first exercise controls dosing, level and release.



SOLID / 150 g

Practice quantity.
Check the capacity of your mold.

Project card

Goal: 12 small unfilled discs.
Mold: 12 shallow open cavities.
Ingredient: 150 g dark molding couverture, including any seed portion required by your method.
Tools: chocolate toolkit on page 3.

Check capacity first

150 g is a practice quantity, not a promise to fill every mold. Measure the cavities using page 5. Scale up if needed; if chocolate remains, spread it on clean food-use paper and handle it according to the product instructions.

One challenge at a time

Do not add fresh fruit, cream, alcohol or colouring to the first trial. A solid piece lets you observe the material without introducing filling storage questions. The result will be the colour of your chocolate, not blue.

Success check: intact shape, even level, surface consistent with the mold.

Discs: from worktop to tray.

Make a repeatable trial, not twelve different pieces.

01

01 / Prepare

Clean and dry the mold and tools. Place everything on a level tray. Prepare the chocolate using your selected method and pass the check on page 8. Record working temperature and time.

02

02 / Dose

Fill one sample cavity, weigh it and use that mass as your reference. Pour close to the cavity rather than from a height. Fill the others to the same level; do not move a flexible mold by holding only one corner.

03

03 / Settle and level

Tap the support gently and in a controlled way to bring air to the surface. Clean the rim with a suitable tool without scratching the mold. Aim for an even back, not necessarily perfection on the first attempt.

04

04 / Set and release

Allow crystallisation under the chocolate maker’s recommended conditions. Time also depends on thickness and surroundings. Test one cavity: if it resists, stop and investigate before forcing the others. Compare three pieces and record the differences.